reconciliation.

- Iran was aspiring to reach the breakout stage within a year or two, and there was therefore still time for negotiations and an agreement based on the 2004 model (see below).
- Iran should not be required to make concessions regarding Israel, such as ending its support for Hezbollah, because that would make it more difficult to reach an agreement on the nuclear issue.

From my perspective, what I identified in the Obama administration was confusion and a lack of determination. This was an administration for whom foreign policy was a nuisance, for whom Israel was a nuisance. It displayed a tendency to appease the "bad guys" rather than confront them. I will address President Trump's position later.

It should be noted that the 2004 model mentioned above was not an American-Iranian agreement that led to Iran halting its military nuclear development for a period of time. Iran made the decision unilaterally following the US invasion of Iraq. That is, the decision was made following a clear military move by the other side, and not as the result of a policy of engagement or of verbal deterrence.

Iran: A Case Study in Obstinacy and Wearing Down the Enemy

Iran emerged defeated from its nine-year war with Iraq, which ended in 1990 on the eve of the outbreak of the First Gulf War. After this war, when the Iraqis were busy invading Kuwait and fighting against the international coalition led by the United States, the Iranians were drawing lessons from their war against Iraq. They concluded that their defeat in the war was the result of the combination of two weapons that the Iraqis had introduced into their ranks during the crucial stages of the war—rockets and missiles launched at Iranian population centers, including the capital Tehran, and chemical weapons, which had been used by the Iraqis on the front lines. The Iranians had no response to these two types of weapons.

As a result of the lessons it learned, Iran decided to invest its efforts into developing nonconventional military capabilities in order to build up its strategic power. For the first time, it was decided to build chemical and biological capabilities in parallel, as well as missile and rocket launching